

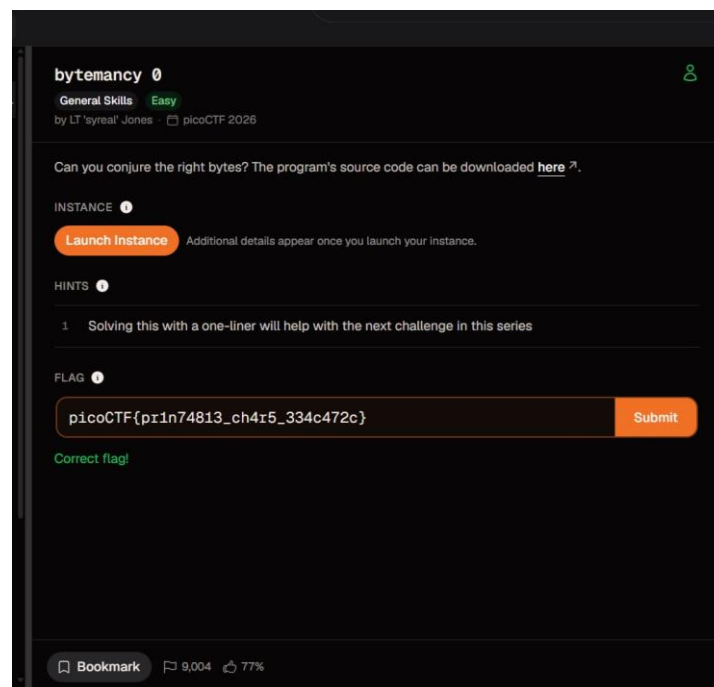
Challenge Write-Up Template

Challenge Information

Student Name	Keyzia Joy Pascua
Section / Class	BSIT 3 - Networking
Challenge Name	bytemancy 0
Category	General Skills
Points / Difficulty	Easy
Date Solved	August 11, 2026
Flag Format Given	picoCTF{...}

1. Challenge Description

This challenge is a good first look at how many CTF services work: you connect, the service tells you exactly what it wants, and your job is to give it back in the right format. Here, the service asks for the ASCII character represented by decimal value 101, repeated three times side-by-side with no spaces. Solving it is really about knowing (or looking up) the ASCII table and following the instructions precisely.



2. Initial Analysis / Reconnaissance

Before writing any code or guessing, always connect to a network-based challenge first and read what it actually says - don't assume based on the challenge name or description alone. Using netcat (nc host port) is the standard way to do this: it opens a raw TCP connection and lets you see the server's banner and prompt directly. Once you see exact wording like 'send ASCII DECIMAL 101 side-by-side, no space,' you know this is an encoding/conversion challenge rather than a binary or web challenge, and you can plan your input accordingly instead of guessing.

3. Tools and Commands Used

Tool / Command	What it was used for	Result / Output
nc candy-mountain.picoctf.net 59418	Open a raw connection to the challenge service so you can read its exact prompt	BYTEMANCY-0 banner + instruction to send ASCII decimal 101, 101, 101, side-by-side, no space
ASCII table (decimal-to-character lookup)	Look up what character decimal 101 represents	101 = 'e'
eee (typed into the open netcat session)	Send the requested characters back to the service	picoCTF{pr1n74813_ch4r5_334c472c}

4. Solution Walkthrough

Step 1

Start every General Skills / network challenge the same way: connect first, read second, act third. Run nc <host> <port> to open the connection. The service will usually print a banner and then tell you exactly what input format it expects - in this case, 'Send me ASCII DECIMAL 101, 101, 101, side-by-side, no space.' Reading this carefully before typing anything avoids wasted guesses.

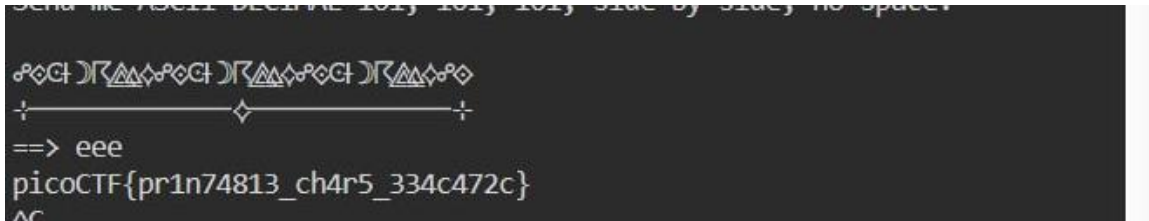
```
pascuakeyzia-academy@webshell:~$ nc candy-mountain.picoctf.net 59418
÷————[ BYTEMANCY-0 ]————÷
p00t 0R445p00t 0R445p00t 0R445p00t
Send me ASCII DECIMAL 101, 101, 101, side-by-side, no space.
```

Step 2

Once you know the server wants a specific ASCII value, convert it before you send anything. ASCII decimal 101 maps to the lowercase letter 'e' (this can be checked instantly with an ASCII table or python3 -c "print(chr(101))"). Since the prompt asked for that value three times, side-by-side with no spaces, the string you need to send is simply "eee" - not "e e e" and not the number 101 itself.

Step 3

With the correct string worked out, type it directly into the still-open netcat session and press Enter. The server evaluates whatever you send against its expected answer, so accuracy matters - extra spaces or the wrong character count would fail. Here, sending eee causes the service to respond immediately with the flag: picoCTF{pr1n74813_ch4r5_334c472c}.



```
Send me ASCII decimal 101, 101, 101, side by side, no space  
picoCTF{pr1n74813_ch4r5_334c472c}
```

Additional steps (add as needed)

5. Flag

picoCTF{pr1n74813_ch4r5_334c472c}

6. Key Concept / What I Learned

The core takeaway is ASCII encoding: the mapping between decimal byte values and the printable characters they represent. Being able to convert quickly between decimal/hex values and characters is a skill that comes up constantly in later reverse engineering, binary exploitation, and network protocol challenges, so it's worth being comfortable with an ASCII table or a one-line script for it.

7. References

Standard ASCII table (e.g. [asciitable.com](https://www.asciitable.com)) - useful any time a challenge gives you a decimal or hex byte value and expects the corresponding character.
